FICTIONAL TRAINING CASE

Project Horizon – IT Hardware Procurement

All names, companies, dates and figures are fictional and created for training.

Complaint

Anonymous report: IT Admin Lead favoured Nexa Tech Supplies for a laptop purchase.

Email 1 – 05 Jan

IT Admin Lead asks Nexa for a quote “matching the budget of ■24 lakh”.

Email 2 – 08 Jan

Another bidder asks why its lower quote was not considered.

Email 3 – 09 Jan

Nexa sales representative to IT Admin Lead: “As discussed over dinner, we'll take care of you.”

Invoice NX-501 – 10 Jan

■23.9 lakh — 40 laptops.

PO-7730 – 12 Jan

■23.9 lakh to Nexa; approved by the IT Admin Lead.

Invoice NX-502 – 15 Jan

■23.9 lakh — 40 laptops, same description.

Investigation caution

The case contains potential indicators that may warrant review. The evidence does not by itself establish favoritism, bid-rigging, bribery, conflict of interest, order splitting or any other misconduct. Investigators must verify the facts and consider alternative explanations.